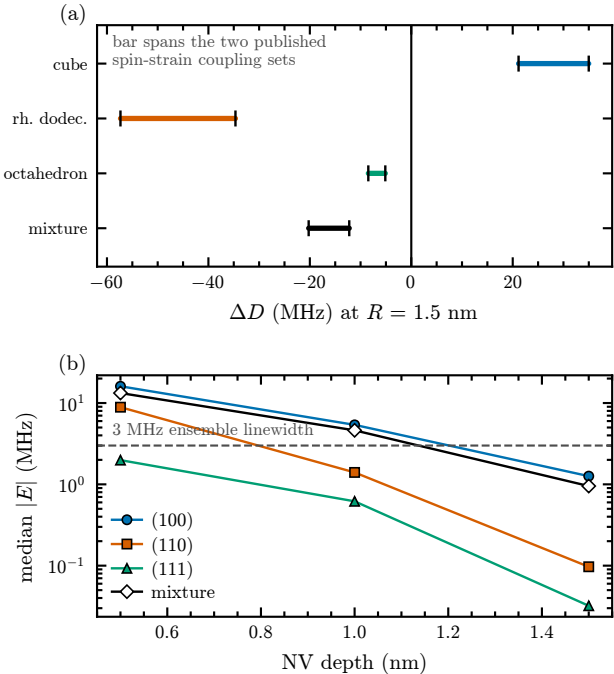




D and E are different kinds of quantity, and the figure is drawn to make that visible. (a) The axial shift ΔD at $R = 1.5$ nm, each bar spanning the two published spin-strain coupling sets -- the bar width IS the coupling uncertainty, about 1.65x, and it dominates every other error here. ΔD is a VOLUME AVERAGE: it depends only on which facets are present and on nothing about where an NV sits. (b) The transverse splitting —E— against NV depth, which has no counterpart in (a)'s framing at all. For a symmetry-complete habit the volume-averaged E is exactly zero, so (b) exists only because the field is resolved in position: E is generated by the edge-concentrated deviatoric stress and falls roughly 4x per 0.5 nm of depth as the site retreats from the edges that carry the load. It is NOT driven by the (100) anisotropy -- zeroing that leaves 54% of E on a cube. Both panels use literature C11/C12/C44 and published coupling sets, neither fitted here. Epistemic level L1.